Workplace Harassment Policy

Richtlinie zum Schutz vor Belästigung und Diskriminierung am Arbeitsplatz

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Owner	Julia Neumann, HR Director
Approved by	Dr. Katharina Weber, CEO (Geschäftsführerin)
Consulted	Thomas Bauer, Works Council Chair (Betriebsrat); Dr. Nadia Petrov, General Counsel and Data Protection Officer; Mariam Haddad, HR Business Partner and EAP Officer
Applies to	All employees, trainees, working students, interns, contractors and temporary agency staff at all sites (Munich, Berlin, Garching, Frankfurt), in remote work, on business trips and at company events; also covers conduct towards customers, visitors and other third parties
Classification	Internal
Language	English. A German version is available from HR on request.

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1 Purpose

Our anti-harassment policy expresses our commitment to maintain a workplace that is free of harassment, so that our employees can feel safe and happy. We will not tolerate anyone intimidating, humiliating or sabotaging others in our workplace. We also prohibit wilful discrimination based on the grounds named in the General Equal Treatment Act (Allgemeines Gleichbehandlungsgesetz, AGG): race or ethnic origin, gender, religion or belief, disability, age and sexual identity.

This policy also covers sexual harassment and harassment by people from outside our company. It supplements the Employee Code of Conduct (NS-HR-POL-001).

2 Scope

This policy applies to all employees, contractors, visitors, customers and anyone else whom employees come into contact with at work. It applies at our sites, in remote work and video calls, on business trips, at company events, and in work-related chats, email and social media.

3 What is harassment in the workplace

Harassment includes bullying (Mobbing), intimidation, direct insults, malicious gossip and victimization. We cannot create an exhaustive list, but here are some examples of behaviour that we consider harassment:

Type	Examples
Sabotage and exclusion	Sabotaging someone's work on purpose; deliberately withholding information needed for the job.
Unwanted advances	Engaging in frequent or unwanted advances of any nature; unwanted physical contact; sexual comments or images.
Derogatory comments	Commenting derogatorily on a person's ethnic heritage or religious beliefs, or on their age, disability, gender or sexual identity.
Rumours	Starting or spreading rumours about a person's personal life.
Humiliation	Ridiculing someone in front of others, or singling them out to perform tasks unrelated to their job (for example bringing coffee) against their will.

Sexual harassment is a violation of the AGG and, in serious cases, a criminal offence. We will investigate all relevant reports seriously. If an employee is found to have committed sexual harassment, this will lead to serious disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment (see section 8).

4 Harassment by third parties

Harassment can also come from customers, suppliers, visitors or other people outside Norvane Systems. We do not expect you to put up with it. Report it in the same way as any other harassment (section 5). Depending on the case, we will talk to the person or their employer, change contact arrangements, or end a business relationship or ban a visitor from our premises. Your manager must not ask you to tolerate such behaviour in order to keep a customer.

5 How to address harassment

If you are being harassed, whether by a colleague, customer or vendor, you can choose to talk to any of the following:

Who	When this is a good option	Contact
The person concerned	If you suspect that they do not realize they are harassing you, you can talk to them directly in an effort to resolve the issue. This is appropriate for cases of minor harassment (for example inappropriate jokes between colleagues). Avoid this approach with customers or other stakeholders.	n/a
Your line manager	If customers, stakeholders or team members are involved in your complaint. Your manager will assess the situation and must inform HR where appropriate.	Your manager
HR (Beschwerdestelle)	In any case of harassment, no matter how minor it may seem. Contact HR as soon as possible in cases of serious harassment (for example sexual advances) or if your manager is involved. HR is our complaints office under the AGG.	hr@norvane.example, ext. 2000
Confidential counselling (EAP)	If you want to talk first and decide on next steps afterwards.	Mariam Haddad, eap@norvane.example, ext. 2010
Works Council (Betriebsrat)	If you want support from the employee representation. You may bring a member to any meeting about your complaint.	betriebsrat@norvane.example, ext. 2500
Ethics hotline	If you prefer to report outside your line of management, or the complaint involves a senior manager.	ethics@norvane.example, ext. 2650

You can also contact the Federal Anti-Discrimination Agency (Antidiskriminierungsstelle des Bundes) for independent advice. Please note that legal deadlines may apply to claims under the AGG; HR or the Works Council can advise you.

6 How we handle a complaint

Step	What happens	Who	Target time
1	Complaint received and acknowledged in writing.	HR	2 working days
2	Initial confidential conversation with the person who complained; interim protective measures are agreed if needed (for example changed seating, team or remote days).	HR, with Works Council member on request	5 working days

3	Investigation: both sides are heard, witnesses and evidence are considered. The person concerned is told of the allegations and can respond.	HR, Legal where needed	Normally within 30 days
4	Decision and measures, communicated to both parties.	HR Director, with the responsible Managing Director	5 working days after step 3
5	Follow-up conversation to check that the behaviour has stopped.	HR	About 4 weeks later

If the complaint is about HR staff or the HR Director, it is handled by the General Counsel (ethics@norvane.example).

7 Protection and confidentiality

Anything you disclose will remain confidential and is shared only with the people who need to know in order to handle the complaint. Personal data in complaint files is processed in line with the Data Protection Policy (NS-LEG-POL-001). Nobody may be disadvantaged for making a complaint in good faith or for supporting a colleague as a witness; retaliation is itself a breach of this policy. Knowingly false accusations are also a breach of this policy.

8 Disciplinary consequences

Consequences for harassment depend on the severity of the offence, and may include a conversation with a manager, counselling, training, a formal warning (Abmahnung), a transfer, or termination of employment. In serious cases, including sexual harassment, termination without notice may be justified. Termination follows German employment law, and the Works Council (Betriebsrat) is heard before any termination. Third parties may be banned from our premises or systems.

9 Key contacts

Topic	Contact	Email	Ext.
Complaints office (Beschwerdestelle)	HR team	hr@norvane.example	2000
Policy owner	Julia Neumann, HR Director	julia.neumann@norvane.example	2001
Confidential counselling (EAP)	Mariam Haddad, HR Business Partner	eap@norvane.example	2010
Employee representation	Thomas Bauer, Works Council Chair	betriebsrat@norvane.example	2500
Ethics hotline	Dr. Nadia Petrov, General Counsel	ethics@norvane.example	2650
Immediate danger, building security (24/7)	Building security	security@norvane.example	9111

In an emergency call 112 (emergency services) or 110 (police).

10 Related documents

Document ID	Title	Relevance
NS-HR-POL-001	Employee Code of Conduct	Relationships at work, social media
NS-HR-POL-004	Workplace Policies	Further workplace rules
NS-LEG-POL-001	Data Protection Policy	Handling of complaint files

11 Version history

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	01.06.2023	Julia Neumann	First issue.
1.1	15.04.2024	Julia Neumann	Added harassment by third parties.
1.2	01.03.2025	Jordan Ellis	Added complaint procedure and contact table.
1.3	01.09.2026	Julia Neumann	Revised after consultation with the Works Council; aligned with the AGG; target times added.

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